

STAGE SIX • COMMUNICATION: SPEAKING, READING & WRITING

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • FAQ

Stage Six • Communication: Speaking, Reading & Writing

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Six, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. There are seventy FIRSTS in this stage — do I really need to do every single one?

A: The Templates workbook covers all seventy so you have the full toolkit, but your facilitator may choose to run only a subset live as group exercises. Completing your own worksheets for all seventy is still the goal, even if not every one gets group discussion time.

Q2. I genuinely hate watching or listening to recordings of myself — is there any way around this?

A: The discomfort is normal and, honestly, part of the point — it's the only way to catch habits invisible from the inside. You never have to share the recording with anyone else; the value is entirely in your own private review.

Q3. What if I completely freeze during the impromptu speaking drill?

A: That's a genuinely common first-time reaction, not a failure. The exercise is designed for repeated practice, not a single perfect performance — it gets easier with reps, and freezing once doesn't mean anything about your actual ability.

Q4. I'm not a naturally strong writer — will this stage actually help, or is it more for people who are already good at it?

A: This stage is specifically structured around deliberate practice and self-editing, which tend to help less-confident writers more than naturally strong ones, since it replaces vague self-doubt with a concrete, repeatable process.

Q5. What if the person I want to practice a difficult conversation with (FIRST I42) is someone I have a real, current conflict with?

A: Consider practicing with a hypothetical or past scenario in the group setting, and save the real conversation for outside the session once you've built the skill in a lower-stakes context first.

Q6. Is it normal that my communication style seems to shift depending on who I'm talking to?

A: Yes — adapting your style to your audience (FIRST I17, I51) is a genuine communication skill, not inconsistency. The concern would be if you can't communicate clearly at all in a given context, not that you communicate differently across contexts.

Q7. How do I know if my public speaking anxiety (FIRST I40) is just normal nerves or something I should get more support for?

A: Normal nerves are manageable with practice and tend to ease somewhat with repetition. If anxiety feels persistently overwhelming regardless of preparation, or significantly limits your daily life beyond public speaking specifically, it's worth talking to a counselor or your school's student support services — this program can build skill, but it's not a substitute for that kind of support if it's genuinely needed.